



NITI Aayog

DRAFT



SECTOR AT A GLANCE

Urban Housing

Urban Sector in India

2023-Urban-SAG-02

Sector at a Glance

Urban Housing

Urban Sector in India

The '**Sector-at-a-Glance**' provides an easy-to-read overview and basic understanding of a sector, sub-sector, or thematic area. The facts and insights on the sector are supported by relevant data and best practices from credible government and multilateral sources. The document covers the structure, key trends, opportunities and challenges, government initiatives, and the way forward for the sector.

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Introduction

This document serves as a primer for understanding **urban housing** in India. This document provides basic information on the sector – fundamental concepts, key trends, central government priorities and example of potential interventions.

This document attempts to answer the following questions:

- What is the significance of urban housing in India?
- What does urban housing cover?
- What is the status of housing in urban India?
- How can housing shortage be assessed? How is affordable housing defined?
- How is the housing sector governed?
- What are the Central Government's priorities?
- What are some potential interventions going forward?

What is the significance of urban housing in India?

A. Housing – a fundamental right

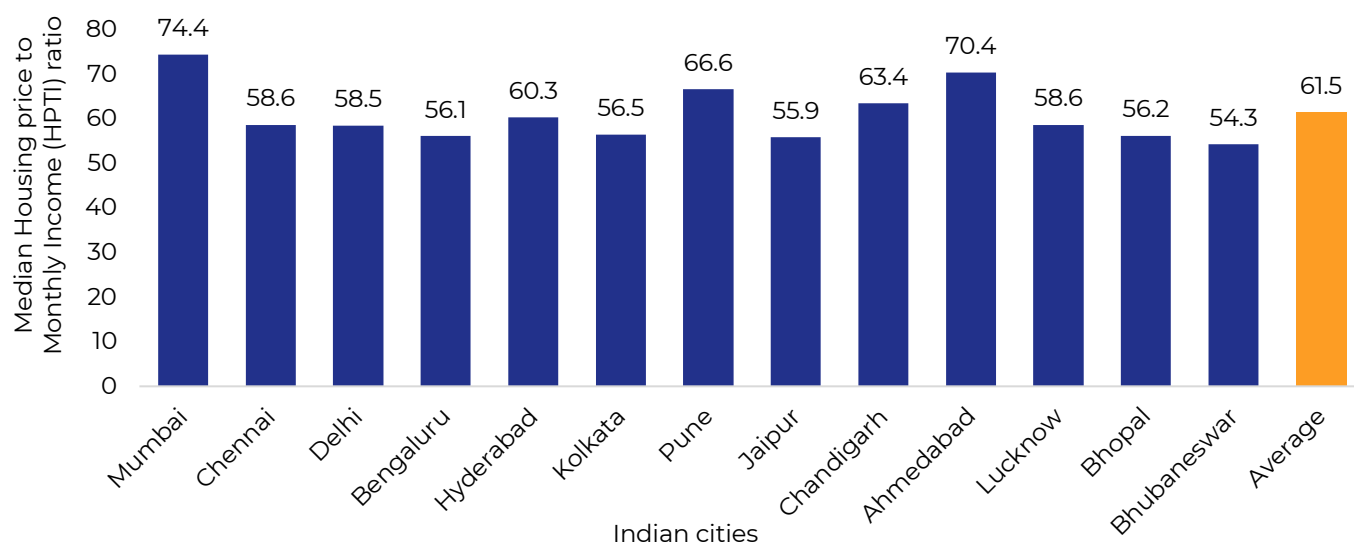
The Supreme Court of India has emphasised on the significance of housing. In its 1995 verdict (Chameli Singh Vs. State of Uttar Pradesh), it interpreted Article 19(1)(e) and Article 21 of the Constitution of India to state that access to a house of adequate quality and size is a fundamental right and vital for human life. This is also recognised under the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, 1948 and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 1966, to which India is a signatory.

- “All citizens shall have the right to...to reside and settle in any part of the territory of India.” – Article 19 (1) (e) of the Constitution of India
- “No person shall be deprived of his life or personal liberty except according to procedure established by law.” – Article 21 of the Constitution of India.
- “It is home where he has opportunities to grow physically, mentally, intellectually and spiritually. Right to shelter, therefore, includes adequate living space, safe and decent structure, clean and decent surroundings, sufficient light, pure air and water, electricity, sanitation and other civic amenities like roads etc. so as to have easy access to his daily avocation. The right to shelter, therefore, does not mean a mere right to a roof over one's head but right to all the infrastructure necessary to enable them to live and develop as a human being.” – Supreme Court of India (1995), Chameli Singh vs State Of Uttar Pradesh.
- “Everyone has the right to a standard of living adequate for the health and well-being of himself and his family including food, clothing, housing, medical care and necessary social services.” – Article 25(1), Universal Declaration of Human Rights, 1948 (United Nations)
- “The right to everyone to an adequate standard of living for himself and his family including food, clothing, housing and to the continuous improvement of living conditions.” – Article 11 (1) of International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 1966 (United Nations)

B. Economic dimension of housing

Expenditure on housing can take up a third or larger share of a household's monthly income, sharply driving up the cost of living. The graph below indicates that median housing price-to-income ratio is in the range of 50% to 75%, indicating low affordability for majority of households.

Figure 1: Variation of housing affordability across Indian cities as of March 2019 (based on loans disbursed)



Source: Reserve Bank of India¹

Table 1: Contribution of housing sector to the Indian economy

Residential Construction Sector ^a		Rs. 1 invested in Housing
1.0% of GDP	6.9% of employment	+ Rs. 2.84 ^b to GDP

^aIncludes urban as well as rural,

^bIncludes induced effect of household expenditure.

Source: National Council of Applied Economic Research²

C. Climate impact of housing

Housing is a major source of CO₂ emissions, and urban energy requirements are rapidly increasing, given the rise in per capita consumption and growth in population.

Table 2: Climate impact of housing

Global CO ₂ emissions from buildings ^c (2021)	Increase in per capita urban household electricity consumption (2004-2011)	Increase in annual urban household electricity consumption (2004-2011)
37%	29%	60%

Source: UNEP (2022)³, Itkelwar, et al. (2020)⁴

^c Includes residential as well as non-residential buildings, covering emissions from buildings operations

¹ Reserve Bank of India. (2019). *Residential Asset Price Monitoring Survey*.

² Bhide, S., Gupta, D.B., Munjal, P. & Kolli, R. (2014). *Impact of Investment in the Housing Sector on GDP and Employment in the Indian Economy*. National Council of Applied Economic Research.

³ United Nations Environment Programme. (2022). *Global Status Report for Buildings and Construction*.

⁴ Itkelwar, S., Tewari, D., Natarajan, B., & Kumar, S. (2020). *Residential Energy Data Management: Alliance for an Energy Efficient Economy*. Alliance for an Energy Efficient Economy (AEEE).

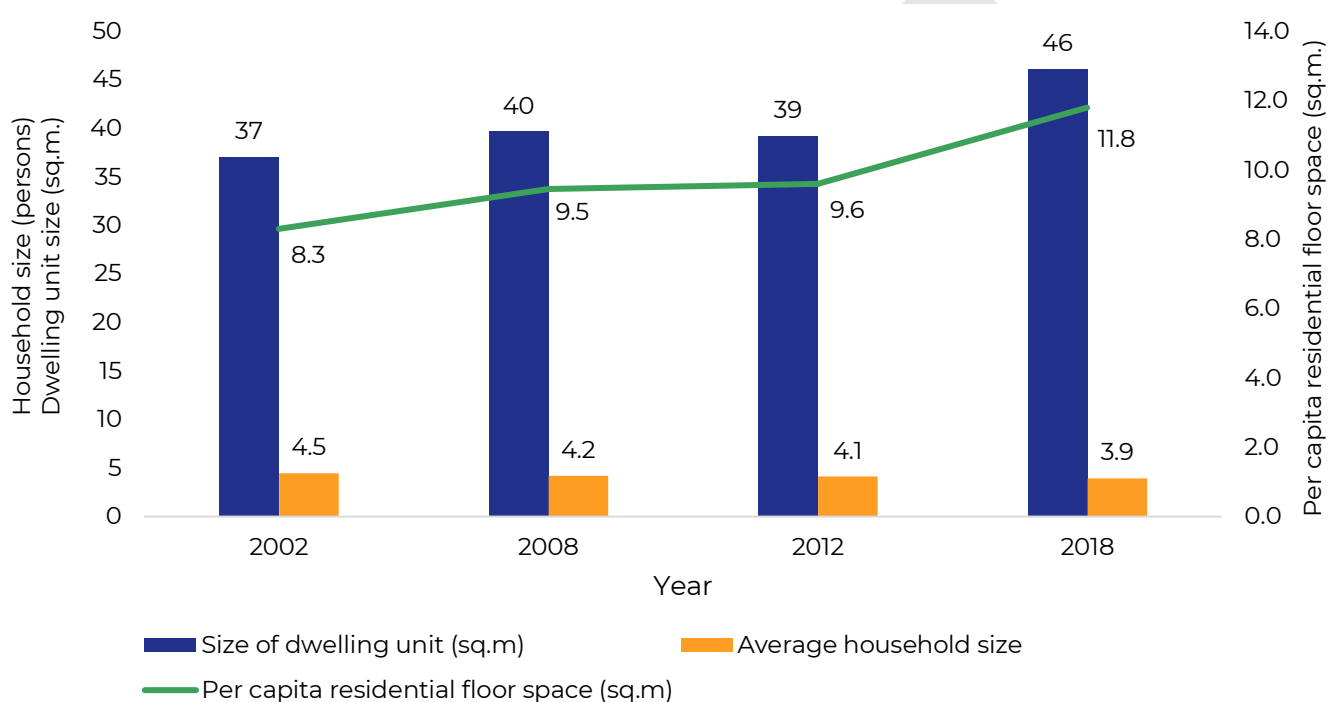
from construction and material production

Emissions can be categorised as (i) operational emissions and (ii) embodied emissions. Different policy approaches are needed to address these two categories of emissions. The energy consumed in the use of buildings is categorised as operational emissions. Embodied emissions are associated with construction, renovation and demolition of buildings. This includes emissions arising from production and transport of building materials as well as building construction and demolition activities. Embodied emissions account for a significant share (20% to 50%) of an average building's life-cycle emissions.⁵

D. Sizeable future demand for housing

Indian's urban population is estimated to increase to more than double, from 377 million in 2011 to 838 million by 2047.⁶ The urban housing demand will likely grow even more rapidly, with increasing per capita floor space demand.

Figure 2: Size of household, dwelling unit and per capita floor area in urban India (2002-2018)



Source: National Statistical Office, Data for 2002, 2012, 2009 and 2018⁷

⁵ C40 Cities Climate Leadership Group. (2020, October). *Why cities need to address the construction sector's hidden emissions*. C40 Knowledge Hub.

⁶ United Nations (2019). *World Urbanization Prospects: The 2018 Revision*. World Bank.

⁷ National Statistical Office. (2018). *Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing Condition in India (NSS 76th Round)*. Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation. New Delhi;

National Statistical Office. (2012). *Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing Condition in India*. Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation. New Delhi;

National Statistical Office. (2009). *Housing Condition and Amenities in India (NSS 65th Round)*. Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation. New Delhi;

National Statistical Office. (2002). *Housing Condition in India (NSS 58th Round)*. Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation. New Delhi.

What is the status of housing in urban India? —

The prevalence of a significant stock of vacant real estate in contrast to the number of households dwelling in inadequate housing presents the conundrum in the state of housing in urban India. Constraints of both demand and supply side dynamics has limited the growth of the urban housing markets over the last few decades.

A. Housing stock

Table 3: Status of Housing stock in India

Occupied residences (2011)	Vacant real estate units (2011)	Pucca houses (2018)
78.9 million	11.1 million	96%

Source: Census of India (2011)⁸, National Statistical Office (2018)¹⁰

B. Housing Vulnerability among Households

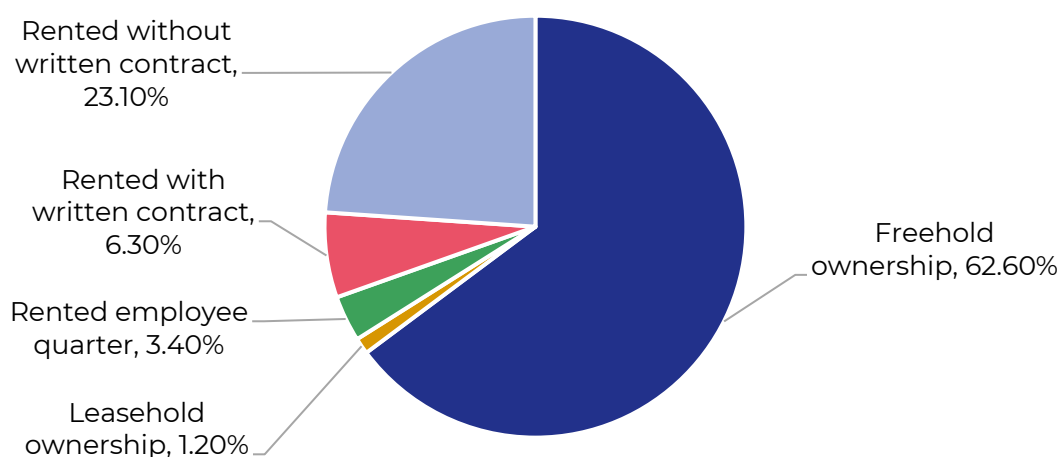
Table 4: Status of housing vulnerability in India

Urban Households (Total)	Slum households	Homeless households ⁹
80.9 million	13.7 million (17.0%)	0.3 million (0.3%)

Source: Census of India (2011), National Statistical Office (2018)⁸

C. Housing tenure

Figure 3: Tenure of houses (2018)



Source: National Statistical office (2018)¹⁰

⁸ Office of Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India. (2011). *Census of India*.

⁹ The Indian government considers the official Census of India definition of homelessness and defines 'houseless people' as, persons who are not living in buildings or 'census houses.' A census house refers to 'a structure with roof.' Hence for measuring the extent of homelessness or determining eligibility programmes and services, the government considers those who 'live in the open on roadside, pavements, in hume pipes, under flyovers and staircases, or in the open in places of worships, mandaps (porch), railway platforms, etc.', as houseless people. – *Census of India 2011*

¹⁰ National Statistical Office. (2018). *Drinking Water, Sanitation, Hygiene and Housing Condition in India (NSS 76th Round)*. Ministry of Statistics and Program Implementation, New Delhi.

D. Housing finance

With the surge in demand for housing, several initiatives have been taken at the central level to improve the robustness of the country's housing finance markets. The Reserve Bank of India and National Housing Bank promote Housing Finance Institutions and provide direct finance and re-finance support for the development of housing finance in the country. Lowering of the tax burden on home buyers, particularly in the affordable housing segment, has boosted demand as well as encouraged developers to construct housing to meet the increase in demand. A steady growth in the disbursement of individual housing loans has been witnessed owing to lower interest rates and increase in affordability due to the consistent measures undertaken by the government to boost the real estate market.

How can housing shortage in urban India be assessed?

Inadequate housing is generally characterised by quality of structure, overcrowding and obsolete units.

A. Housing demand and supply paradox

It is noted that, as per 2011 census, there were 11.09 million vacant houses out of the 110.14 million total houses (i.e., 10%) in urban areas. Economically Weaker Section (EWS) and Lower Income Groups (LIG) make up 96% of the demand arising out of housing shortage. This highlights the mismatch of demand and supply of housing typologies guided by urban and economic policies shaping the housing market. It also highlights the highly segmented and dynamic nature of the housing market.

According to the report of the Technical Group on Urban Housing Shortage (2012-17), 80% of the housing shortage, which was then estimated at 18.78 million, comprised households living in congested units and over 10% in obsolete structures. Further, 90% of this shortage is from EWS and LIG households.

B. Housing shortage estimated by TG-12

Table 5: Housing shortage estimate by TG-12

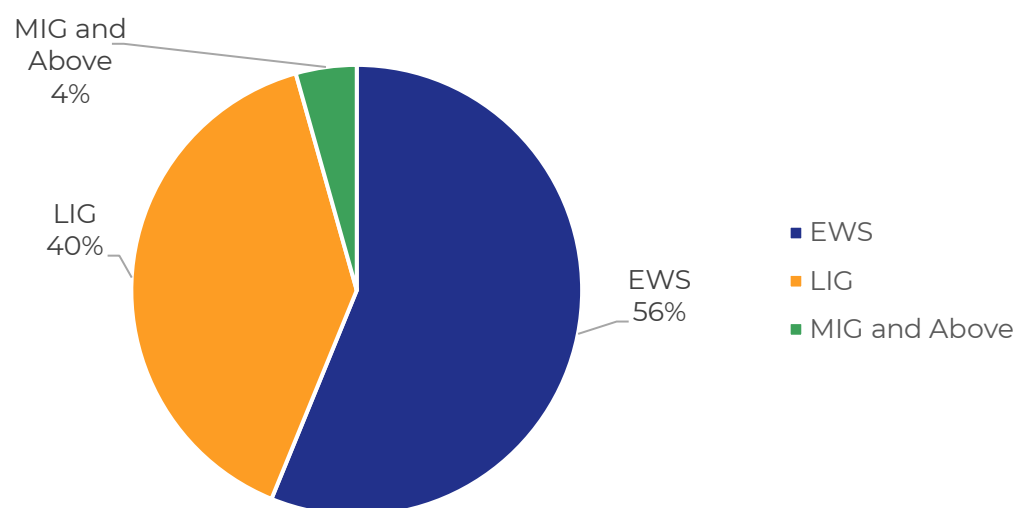
Housing demand category	No. of housing units (in million)	No of Housing Units (%)
Households living in non-serviceable <i>kutcha</i> (makeshift) houses	0.99	5.27%
Households living in obsolescent houses	2.27	12.09%
Households living in congested houses, requiring new houses	14.99	79.82%
Households in homeless condition	0.53	2.82%
Total	18.78	100%

Source: Technical Group On Urban Housing Shortage (TG-12) (2012)¹¹

The ongoing 'Housing for All' initiative of the Government of India has been targeted to address the housing shortage through four components or verticals – (i) In-situ Slum Redevelopment (ISSR), (ii) Credit Linked Subsidy Scheme (CLSS), (iii) Affordable Housing in Partnership (AHP), and (iv) Beneficiary-led

¹¹ Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (2012). *Report of the Technical Group on Urban Housing Shortage (TG-12) for 2012-17*.

Figure 4: % Break-up of housing shortage estimate (2012) by income category



Source: Technical Group On Urban Housing Shortage (TG-12) (2012)¹²

C. Demand assessment under PMAY (Urban) Housing for All

Under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY) - Urban, states were required to submit housing requirements considering slum households and undertake a demand-based approach to assess requirement from non-slum households.

Surveyed demand by States and UTs

112.24 lakh

In response to the above situation, the central government had launched the Housing for All policy in the year 2015, which estimated the national demand for housing at 12.3 million across the four components/ verticals, out of which 11.3 million houses have been grounded and 7.8 million completed as of July 2023.¹³

What are slums?

Census of India's definition

The Census of India 2011 defines 'slums' as 'residential areas where dwellings are unfit for human habitation by reasons of dilapidation, overcrowding, faulty arrangements and design of such buildings, narrowness or faulty arrangement of street, lack of ventilation, light, or sanitation facilities or any combination of these factors which are detrimental to safety and health'.

- **Notified slums:** All notified areas in a town or city notified as 'slum' by State, Union Territory Administration or Local Government under any Act including a 'Slum Act'
- **Recognised slums:** All areas recognised as 'slum' by State, UT Administration or Local Government, Housing and Slum Boards, which may have not been formally notified as slum under any act
- **Identified slums:** A compact area of a minimum population of 300 or about 60-70 households of poorly built congested tenements in an unhygienic environment, usually with inadequate infrastructure and lacking in proper sanitary and drinking water facilities

According to the 2001 census, 18.3% of the total urban population lived in slums. In 2011, it was found that

¹² Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (2012). *Report of the Technical Group on Urban Housing Shortage (TG-12) for 2012-17*.

¹³ Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (Retrieved 1 December 2023). *MIS Dashboard*.

13.7 million households that comprised 17.4% of the total urban population lived in slums.¹⁴

Definition used for National Statistical Survey (NSO)

The National Statistical Office defines 'slums' as any compact settlement with a collection of poorly built tenements – mostly of temporary nature – crowded together, usually with inadequate sanitary and drinking water facilities in unhygienic conditions – provided at least 20 households lived there. The NSO categorises slums as only 'notified' and 'non-notified slums'.

How is affordable housing defined?

Affordable housing is defined in various contexts such as socio-economic, legal, structural, and infrastructural, and so on. The current definition under the Housing for All initiative being used for the purpose of PMAY-U scheme is the most widely used and accepted one for affordable housing.

Definition under PMAY (Urban) Housing for All

Housing projects where 35% of the houses are constructed for Economically Weaker Section (EWS) category – EWS housing being defined as an all-weather single unit or a unit in a multi-storied super structure having carpet area of up to 30 sq.m. with adequate basic civic services and infrastructure services like toilet, water, electricity etc. Eligibility for such units is defined as any household nuclear family or individual household with an annual income of less than INR 3 lakh.¹⁵

Affordable housing has also been defined as follows for various specific or global purposes:

• Definition by Reserve Bank of India and Department of Economic Affairs (2017)

- Housing project using at least 50% of the Floor Area Ratio (FAR)/Floor Space Index (FSI) for dwelling units with carpet area of not more than 60 square meters.

• Definition by High Level Task Force on Affordable Housing for All (2008)

- In case of EWS/ LIG categories, either cost not exceeding four times household gross annual income or Equated Monthly Instalment (EMI)/ rent not exceeding 30% of household's gross monthly income.
- In case of Middle Income Group (MIG) category, unit size of not more than 111.5 sq.m with either cost not exceeding five times household gross annual income or EMI/ rent not exceeding 40% of household's gross monthly income.

• UN-Habitat's definition of affordability

- Net monthly expenditure on housing does not exceed 30% of total monthly income of the household.

Source:

Department of Economic Affairs. (2017). *Updated Harmonized Master List of Infrastructure Sub-sectors*.

National Housing bank. (2008). *Report of High Level Task Force on Affordable Housing for All*. MoHUA.

UN-Habitat. (2015). *Green Building Interventions for Social Housing*. Nairobi.

What are green buildings?

Green buildings include energy efficiency along with other features such as healthy materials, low GHG emissions, water efficiency, sustainable waste management, resource efficiency, and land use. Often materials and methods used to incorporate green aspects have synergistic properties providing energy efficiency and providing other benefits such as resource efficiency.¹⁶

¹⁴ In 2001 only statutory towns with population over 20,000 were covered whereas in 2011 all 4,041 statutory towns in India were covered.

¹⁵ Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (2021). Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban) Housing for All Scheme Guidelines. <https://pmay-urban.gov.in/uploads/guidelines/62381c744c188-Updated-guidelines-of-PMAY-U.pdf>

¹⁶ UN Habitat. (2015). *Green Building Interventions for Social Housing*.

Indian Green Buildings Council (IGBC)

IGBC offers Green Homes Rating System which rates buildings as Certified, Silver, Gold or Platinum. It also offers IGBC Green Affordable Housing Rating System for PMAY projects, projects designed with carpet area less than or equal to 60 sq. m per dwelling unit – which constitutes at least 70% of the total dwelling units in the project in Tier-1 cities, and projects designed with carpet area less than or equal to 90 sq. m per dwelling unit – which constitutes at least 70% of the total dwelling units in the project in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

Green Rating for Integrated Habitat Assessment (GRIHA)

GRIHA offers GRIHA Rating System which rates housing projects from 1 star to 5 star. It also offers GRIHA for Affordable Housing for PMAY projects and projects which meet the RBI priority-sector lending definition for affordable housing.¹⁷

A. Current status of Green Buildings in India

Table 6: Current status of green buildings in India

Green building certifications issued in 2020	% share of new developments which have been certified as green buildings in 2020	Number of financial institutions offering green building finance in 2020
7.6 million	2%	7

Source: International Finance Corporation (2021)¹⁸

How is the housing sector governed?

A. Laws

Listed below are urban sector central and typical state laws. Other laws concerning land acquisition, real estate regulation, environmental protection, though not specific to urban areas, have a bearing on urban development.

The 74th Constitutional Amendment Act: The 12th Schedule of the Constitutions lists 18 functions of urban local bodies which includes planning of land- use and construction of buildings. slum improvement and upgradation and poverty alleviation.

State Town Planning Act: Governs the preparation of land-use plans and regulation of development through issuance of building permits

Slum Areas (Improvement and Clearance) Act, 1956 and State Slum Acts: Provide for protection of notified slum tenants, improvement and clearance of slum areas

Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016: Provides for regulation of the real estate sector to ensure efficiency, transparency, protection of consumer interests and speedy dispute resolution, and also provides for constitution of real estate regulatory authorities

State Co-operative Societies Act: Governs constitution of co-operative societies including co-operative housing societies

Model Tenancy Act, 2021: Provides for setting up of an authority to regulate renting of premises so as to protect interests of the landlord as well as the tenant. It puts into place a mechanism for dispute resolution between parties involved

¹⁷ RBI follows the Department of Economic Affairs' definition of affordable housing.

¹⁸ International Finance Corporation (2021). *India Green Building Market Maturity Snapshot 2020*.

B. Codes and Regulations

National Building Code, 2016: Prepared by the Bureau of Indian Standards, these national-level guidelines for regulating building construction contains administrative regulations, development control rules and general building requirements; fire safety requirements; stipulations regarding materials, structural design and construction (including safety); building and plumbing services; approach to sustainability; and asset and facility management.

Model Building Bye-laws, 2016 and State- or City-level Development Control and Promotion Regulations: The model bye-laws prepared by the Town and Country Planning Organization covers zoning and Floor Space Ratio (FAR), building permit procedures, architectural as well as structural and infrastructure norms. It also contains specific provisions for universal accessibility, rain-water harvesting, heritage conservation, climate resilience, green buildings. The state- or city-level regulations are prepared under the respective Town Planning Act or Municipal Act.

Eco Niwas Samhita 2018 and 2021: These are residential building energy codes formulated by the Bureau of Energy Efficiency.

State Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA) Regulations and Rules: These govern the functioning of the state-level RERA and lay out procedures and processes for the real estate sector.

Co-operative Housing Society (CHS) Bye-laws: These are prepared under the co-Operative Societies Act and govern the functioning of individual CHS.

C. Institutions

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

Apex authority at the national level responsible for policy formulation, developing and managing programs, co-ordinating with other ministries and state governments on matters related to urban development and housing

National-level urban sector agencies falling under its purview include the Town and Country Planning Organization, National Institute of Urban Affairs and Building Materials & Technology Promotion Council, Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd and Central Public Health and Environmental Engineering Organization (CPHEEO).

National Housing Bank

NHB has been set up under the National Housing Bank Act, 1987. It acts as the principal agency for promoting housing finance institutions and providing support to other financial institutions on matters related to housing finance.

State Urban Development/Housing Department

Nodal agency at the state level for policy formulation, managing programs, co-ordinating with other departments and MoHUA on matters related to urban development. In some states, there is a separate housing department

Housing Boards

These agencies are responsible for promoting housing development and undertaking public sector delivery of affordable and social housing.

Slum Boards/Redevelopment Authorities

These agencies are responsible for identifying slum areas, notifying them under the respective law, assessing beneficiaries and improving or redeveloping slum areas.

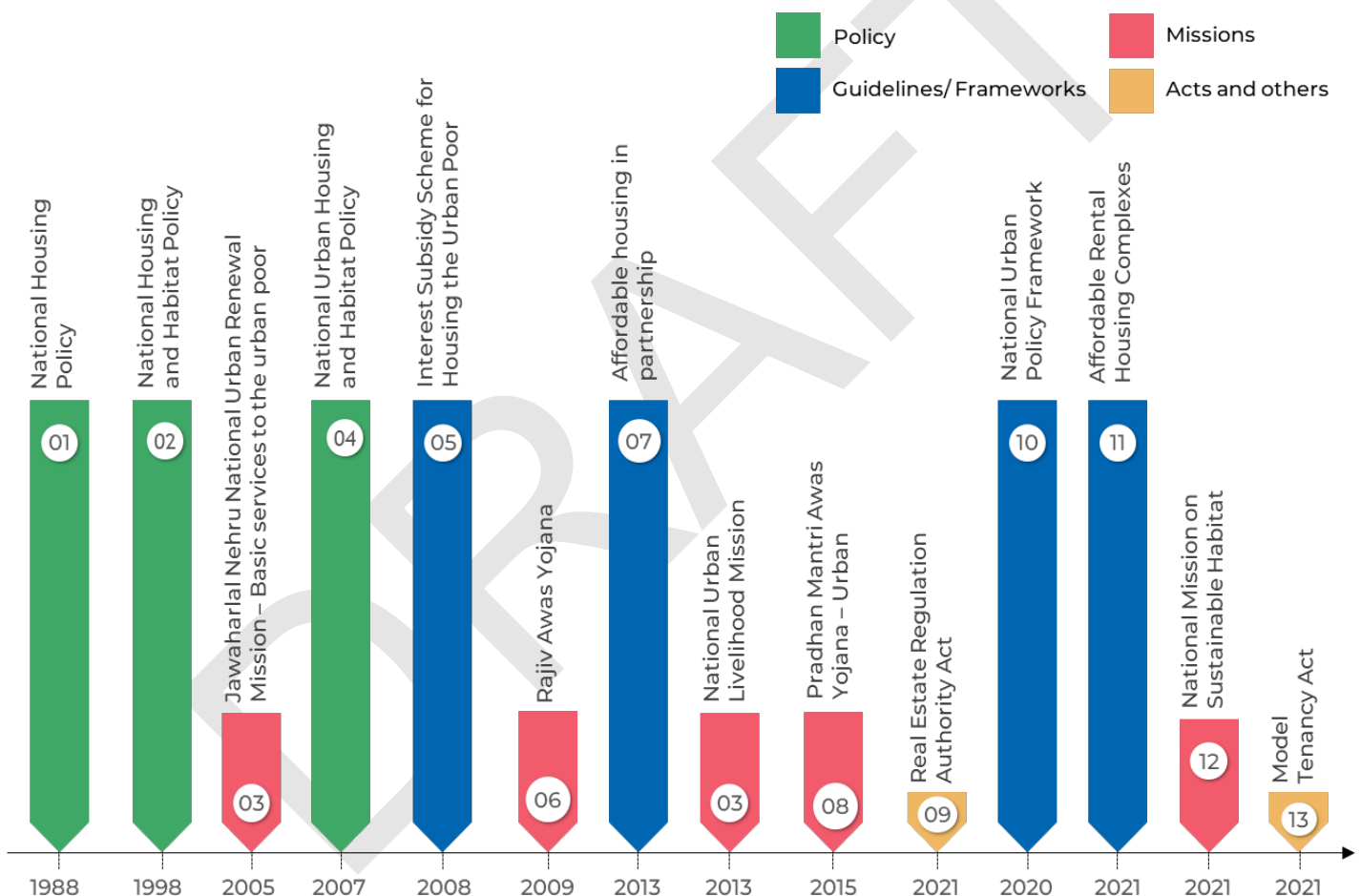
These institutions regulate development and provide building permits. They may also undertake social and affordable housing projects.

What are the central government's priorities?

A. Policy landscape

The first national housing policy was framed in 1988. Today, the national priorities for housing are framed by the National Urban Housing and Habitat Policy (2007), and the National Mission on Sustainable Habitat (2021).

Figure 5: Policy landscape for housing in India



Source: CRISIL research, based on multiple sources

The implementation of Real Estate Regulation Authority (RERA) Act, 2016 has created a transparent and reliable system improving the rights and benefits of home buyers by supporting timely completion and handover of projects by developers. The act also stipulates legally binding processes for real estate transactions, promoting reliability of real estate developers and agents and deterring fraudulent entities from ailing the system.

Additionally, implementation of Model Tenancy Act aims to unlock the vacant housing units for the use in rental housing market by protecting the rights of homeowners and needs of tenants equally.

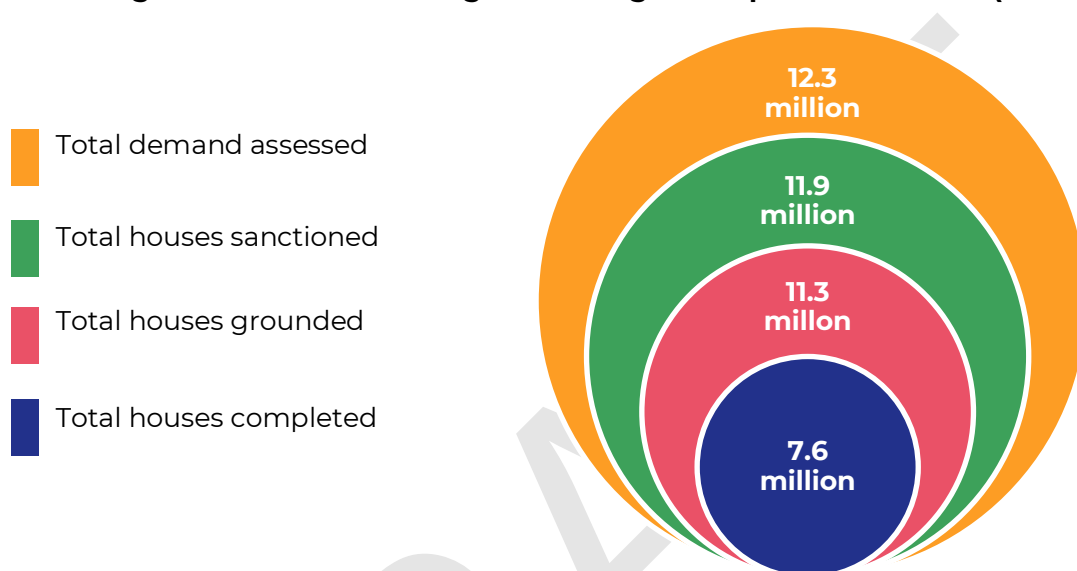
B. Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban) Housing for All

This 2015 mission was aimed at addressing the housing shortfall in the country through four verticals – Affordable Housing In Partnership, Beneficiary-Led Construction, In-Situ Slum Redevelopment And Credit-Linked Subsidy Scheme. Sub-schemes under PMAY include Affordable Rental Housing Complex scheme and the Technology sub-scheme.

Central Assistance committed under PMAY(U)	Central Assistance released under PMAY(U)
INR 2 lakh crore	INR 1.5 lakh crore

Source: MoHUA MIS Dashboard¹⁹

Figure 6: Status of housing units being developed under PMAY (Urban)

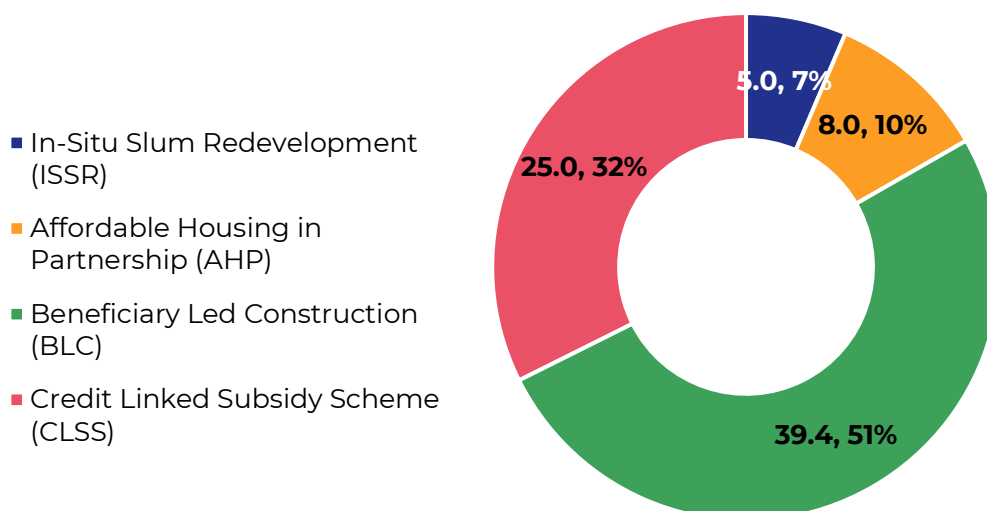


Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (2023)¹⁹

The PMAY (Urban) scheme defines the implementation mechanism for facilitating home ownership across various income groups. The scheme comprehensively targets key issues in the sector through four different verticals and has been implemented at a national scale by treating housing as a basic infrastructural necessity. MoHUA had added Affordable Rental Housing Complexes (ARHCs) as a sub-scheme of PMAY to provide dignified living to urban migrants/ poor near their workplace.

¹⁹ Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (Retrieved 1 December 2023). MIS Dashboard.

**Figure 7: Share of each PMAY-U vertical in completed PMAY (U) projects
(Number of dwelling units in lakhs, share in %)**



Source: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (2023)²⁰

C. Other Central Government initiatives

MoHUA's Shelters for Urban Homeless under DAY-NULM, Global Housing Technology Challenge and National Initiative for Promoting Upskilling of Nirman Workers. Ministry of Finance's Special Window for Affordable and Mid-Income Housing (SWAMIH) fund to support stalled and stressed projects. National Housing Bank's Affordable Housing Fund and Sustainable Use of Natural Resources and Energy Finance (SUNREF) program. Ministry of Power's Eco-Niwas program for energy efficient homes.

What are potential areas of intervention going forward?



City-level Real Estate Information System

Data on various aspects of housing is collected under the National Statistical Surveys, Housing Census, National Family Health Survey, NHB's Residex, and generated as a part of PMAY demand assessment, registration of property transactions, property tax database, issuance of building permits.

This could be consolidated and analysed at the city region level to track housing affordability, housing supply and demand – allowing for a nuanced and evidence-based approach to housing strategy.



Enabling private participation in affordable housing

Private sector engagement – with housing finance institutions on the demand side, with private investors on the supply side – can be deepened.

Drawing from the experience of the Affordable Housing in Partnership vertical of PMAY, financial and non-financial incentives could be further explored. This could include fast-tracking building permits and prioritised infrastructure and public transport connectivity for affordable housing projects.

²⁰ Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (Retrieved 1 December 2023). *MIS Dashboard*.



**Mainstreaming
climate considerations
into housing**

States government, development authorities and ULBs can incorporate into their Development Control Regulations, provisions from the NBC 2016 on sustainability, Model Building Byelaws 2016 on green buildings and climate resilience, as well the Eco Niwas Samhita codes.

The provisions of Handbook on Thermal Comfort in Affordable Housing developed under the Resilient, Affordable and Comfortable Housing Through National Action could be incorporated into design briefs, especially for LIC/EWS and social housing projects. Further, city wide programs to adopt cool roofing would mitigate the impact of the urban heat island effect and reduce thermal discomfort.

Passive strategies for climate resilient housing can be promoted by retaining vernacular architecture styles.

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Recommended Readings

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. (2022). *Housing, Satisfaction and Livelihood: An Impact Assessment of PMAY-U in two States*. <https://pmay-urban.gov.in/storage/materials/Housing-Satisfaction-and-Livelihood-An-Impact-Assessment-of-PMAY-U-in-two-States.pdf>

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